

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; kidney test

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Beyond the organ, kidney-shaped is an established shape descriptor in ordinary non-medical English. It names a recognized form in furniture and landscape design: kidney tables, kidney desks,

kidney trays, and kidney-shaped swimming pools. Retail and design catalogues use the term as a primary product category rather than as a figure of speech; see [1stDibs kidney-shaped tables](#) and [Houzz kidney-shaped pools](#).

This sense is not marginal relative to the literal ones the proposal relies on. In the English Google Books corpus, `kidney-shaped` reaches a higher historical peak than `kidney stone` and remains at roughly two-thirds of its 2022 level. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query](#).

A Kidney character therefore carries an organ sense and a widely used shape sense. The shape sense is offered as an additional meaning, not as the basis for encoding.

B. Use in sequences

Two short combinations express established phrases:

- Kidney + rock: `kidney stone`.
- Kidney + test tube: `kidney tests` or `kidney function tests`.

MedlinePlus uses `kidney stone analysis` for a patient collecting a passed stone for a provider or laboratory, and lists `kidney tests`, `kidney function tests`, and `kidney panel` as established names for blood, urine, and imaging checks. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#) and [Kidney Tests](#).

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no Kidney character, and the current English CLDR annotations associate `kidney` with exactly one emoji:

```
<annotation cp="🫘">beans | food | kidney | legume | small</annotation>
```

That character is U+1FAD8 BEANS. Its CLDR short name is `beans`, and it remains a Food & Drink pictograph. CLDR documents character keywords as words or short phrases used to search for an emoji. The present data therefore connects the organ term to a food pictograph while providing no encoded Kidney character. See the [CLDR English annotations](#) and [CLDR emoji names and keyword guidance](#).

Changing that annotation alone cannot fill the representation gap. Removing `kidney` from Beans would stop the misleading association, but a user searching for `kidney` would still have no recognizable kidney-organ pictograph to find. Encoding Kidney supplies the missing character and allows the term to be associated with the organ it names. Generic medical emoji add care or testing but do not supply that literal noun.

D. Distinctiveness

Kidney is shown as two maroon, inward-facing forms with visible medial notches and a clear diagonal offset. The polished 72-pixel example adds restrained shading and the renal vessels; the

purpose-built 18-pixel example keeps only the two solid notched bodies and the offset, which are the cues that survive at that size. Those cues distinguish it from separate Beans and from the symmetric lobes and top-entering airway of Lungs. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomical detail while preserving the paired notched bodies and the offset.

E. Expected usage level

The most direct evidence of expected usage is that people already send a kidney pictograph. Lacking a Kidney character, writers substitute Beans: third-party emoji reference sites index Beans combinations under kidney and nephrology headings, and practitioners report that the substitution is confusing in the context of kidney disease. That is demand expressed pictographically rather than inferred from word counts, and it is the exhibit this factor rests on first. See [Kidney emoji combinations](#) and [The Case for a Kidney Emoji](#).

Kidney supplies the missing noun in ordinary messages about a stone, test results, dialysis, a transplant, or living donation. U.S. patient guidance uses the exact phrases `kidney stone`, `kidney tests`, `kidney transplant`, and `donate a kidney`; U.K. guidance likewise uses `kidney transplant tests` and explains dialysis when kidneys can no longer filter normally. These are concrete situations in which people collect a stone, discuss results, prepare for treatment, or donate or receive an organ; this is not an argument from medical importance. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#), [Kidney Tests](#), [Kidney Transplant](#), [Living Donation](#), [Kidney Transplant Tests](#), and [Dialysis](#).

The five required frequency exhibits below test the unfiltered term `kidney`; Google Trends and Google Books compare it with `elephant`. They are offered as supporting context rather than as the primary case. The unfiltered term also captures `kidney bean` and disease-related pages, so these counts establish sustained term visibility only, not medical importance or guaranteed emoji use.

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Web Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 211,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Search query.](#)

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Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Video Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 66,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Video Search query.](#)

The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and a search bar contains the word "kidney". To the right of the search bar are icons for clearing the search, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are links for "Sign in", "Settings", and "More". Below the search bar is a horizontal menu with tabs for "All Mode", "All", "Images", "News", "Videos" (which is selected and underlined), "Shopping", "Books", "More", and "Tools".

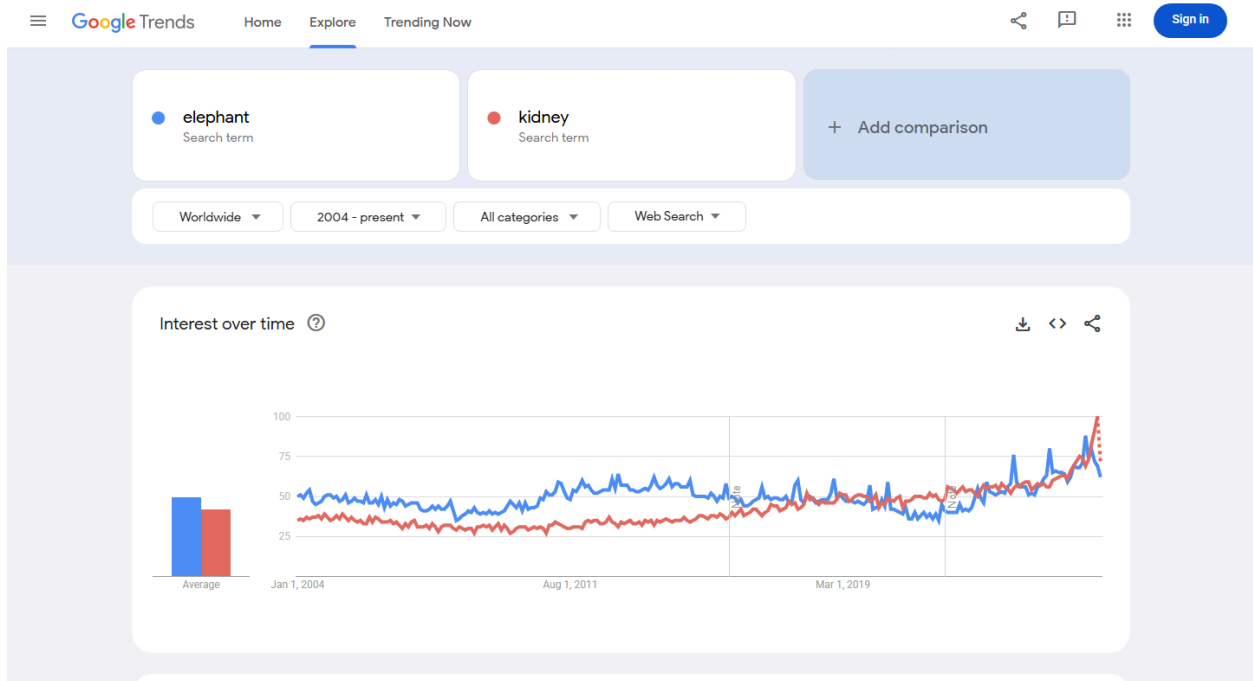
The search results are listed below the menu. Each result includes a thumbnail image, a title, a description, and the source. The results are:

- How Do Kidneys Work?** (YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024). Description: "For more information about the function of kidneys, please https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3 Your kidneys are your body's cle..."
- Get to Know Your Kidneys** (YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024). Description: "Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ..."
- Kidney Function** (YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025). Description: "KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ..."
- How Your Kidneys Work** (YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024). Description: "MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall."
- How kidneys work** (Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021). Description: "How kidneys work — Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine."
- Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease** (YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021). Description: "Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ..."

On the right side of the search results, there is a filter menu. It includes options for "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". At the bottom of this menu, it says "About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)".

Google Trends - Web Search

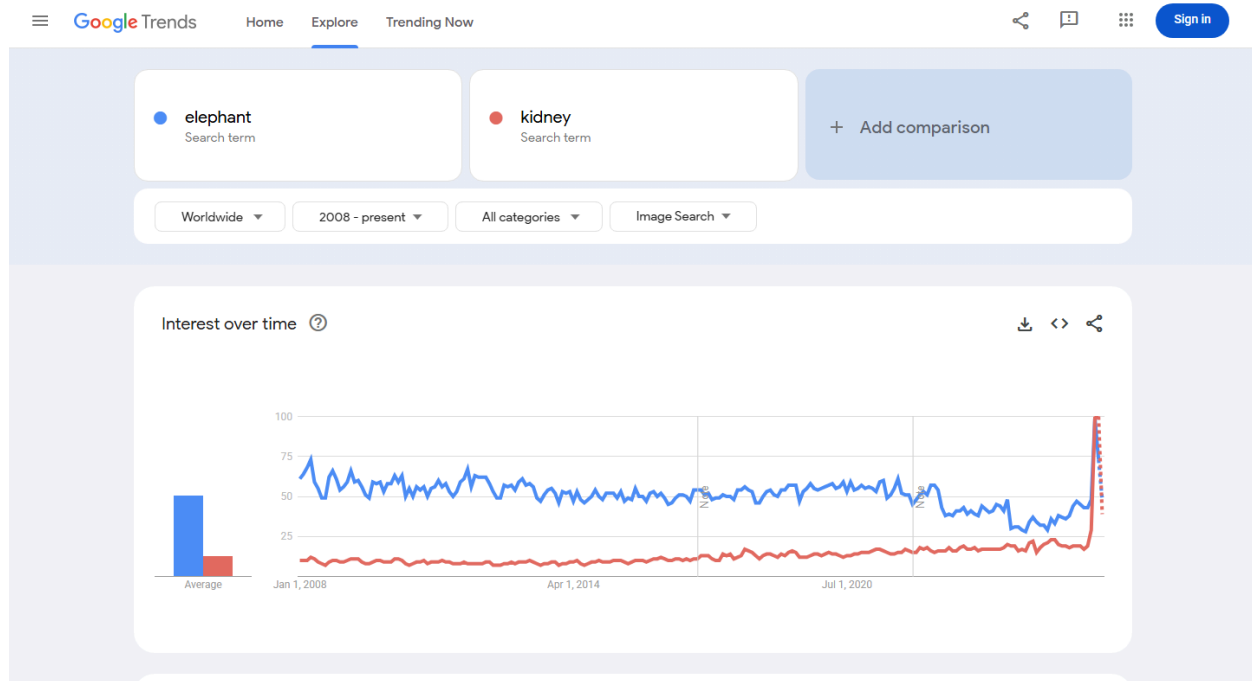
Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Elephant has the higher historical average; kidney remains sustained and reaches comparable or greater interest in recent periods. [Open the reproducible Google Trends Web Search query.](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Kidney shows sustained image-search interest but remains below elephant for most of the displayed range.

[Open the reproducible Google Trends Image Search query.](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query.](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Internal organs are not a fixed set.

G. Compatibility

No legacy carrier set is involved, but CLDR creates a live search-interoperability issue. Its documented emoji search model populates results from user-entered keywords. Current English data assigns `kidney` only to U+1FAD8 BEANS, whose short name is `beans`, while no encoded emoji depicts the organ. See the [CLDR search model](#) and [English annotations](#).

Encoding Kidney resolves the concept-to-character mismatch. Deleting the inaccurate Beans keyword would change a misleading result into no kidney-organ result. Because CLDR assigns keywords, this proposal requests no particular annotation change; it identifies the missing character needed for an accurate result.

Unicode's Emoji 19.0 priorities emphasize empirical use, compatibility with apps, standards, or operating systems, and improvements for existing emoji users. The five frequency exhibits address the first; the CLDR mismatch and demonstrated Beans ambiguity address the latter two. UTC #185 minutes record that compatibility was the theme of the 2025 proposed set and that Monarch Butterfly would not have been recommended without its compatibility rationale. This is process context, not a comparison between the characters. See [L2/25-128](#) and [UTC #185 minutes](#).

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Beans is the strongest existing single emoji, and it is already being used this way. Unicode's own `kidney` keyword makes Beans searchable under the organ term, but searchability is not representation: the result is still a food pictograph. Writers who need the organ reach for it in the absence of anything better. Third-party emoji reference sites independently index Beans combinations under kidney and nephrology headings; see [Kidney emoji combinations](#) and [Nephrology emoji](#). A 2022 editorial in the American Journal of Kidney Diseases describes Beans as among the best available alternatives and reports that it is confusing when used in the context of kidney disease; several authors of that editorial are also submitters here, so it is offered as practitioner testimony rather than independent measurement. See [The Case for a Kidney Emoji](#).

That is the substance of this factor. The question is not whether a substitute can be improvised; it is whether the improvisation works. Beans is named `beans`, is categorized under Food & Drink, and displays food. Beans + Hospital can suggest kidney care but can equally read as food, diet, or beans at a hospital. Beans + Rock does not clearly name `kidney stone`, and Beans + Test Tube does not clearly name `kidney tests`; in each case the reader must first assume that Beans means an organ. Observed substitution shows the need; the recorded confusion shows the substitute does not meet

it. Removing the `kidney` annotation would stop that misleading search result, but would not make the organ representable. A Kidney character supplies the missing noun. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally. The same noun is used in kidney stone analysis, kidney testing, dialysis, transplantation, and living donation; it is not a specific disease, procedure, campaign, organization, or subtype.

C. Open-ended

The closest unencoded neighbors are Liver, Stomach, Pancreas, and Spleen. Kidney has a specific combination that those names cannot simply reuse: kidney stone and dialysis, together with kidney testing and donation/transplant language. Beans and short sequences still fail to identify the organ, the required frequency exhibits show sustained use of its name, and the paired notched form remains legible at small size. Kidney is not proposed because organs are important or because an anatomy set should be completed; encoding it would not establish that every neighboring organ meets the same evidence.

D. Transient

Kidney is an established anatomical term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The embedded Google Books evidence spans 1500-2022, while current NIDDK, MedlinePlus, and HRSA guidance uses the same noun across testing, stones, dialysis, transplantation, and donation.

E. Faulty comparison

Existing organ emoji do not create an entitlement to Kidney. Lungs is used only as a small-size legibility comparison; the Kidney case rests on the named stone, testing, dialysis, transplant, and donation messages, the remaining ambiguity of Beans, the frequency evidence, and the paired notched pictograph.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney identifies the organ concept even though the example shows the familiar paired organs; this proposal does not request separate singular and plural characters. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomy while preserving two inward-facing notched bodies and a visible offset. Vascular anatomy is intentionally omitted from the 18x18 examples, where it does not survive, and retained in the 72x72 examples.

Official guidance: [Unicode Emoji Proposals](#).